

*Good tidings Ambrose,*

*I apologize for my long silence, I know you must have been just so worried about your very most favorite scout, delver, and theorist. While I understand my obligation to return as scheduled and regale the guild with my exploits upriver, I write to you now with my interest thoroughly piqued and the hope that leadership will permit a short extension to my expedition.*

*As we discussed, I've used guild funds to begin the long process of mapping out the western tributaries of the river Wyfloe. I have established a base camp at the southerly branches of the delta alongside mercenary agents from the Morning Stars organization. Upon setting out from the camp I traveled three days by canoe before the barren reed marshes gave way to a deep pinewood forest whereupon the various delta branches converge and the river broadens substantially. For another twelve days I slowly explored west along the the banks of this river. While several branches are blocked by impassable cataracts, the main body of the Wyfloe indeed continues in a southwestern arc back towards the mountains. By my own impeccable estimation, the river hardly narrows at all in the 300-some miles I managed to explore, I'm sure you can envision the implications should the AEC learn about its potential.*

*Surprisingly, I encountered no Aire anywhere on the river's banks and saw no sign of their passing inland. It was on one of these forays where I encountered a... mound. From a distance it appeared as a strangely regular ridge within a clearing in the wood. I heard this whistling sound coming from its direction that caught my attention. I was able to investigate for a few days and even discovered that the ridge seems to be hollow, but as I prepared to delve within, something from within came out to meet me. I'm no brawler and whatever this monstrosity is it was many times my size, so I didn't stick around long enough to get a good look. What stuck with me was it's unnaturally cloying*

scent. Rotting fruit is the closest descriptor I can think of, but this had zero sourness to it. Between a perfectly straight landform inside a perfectly circular clearing with no nearby wildlife besides a strange and unnatural behemoth, I think there's something down there, and I want to go back with numbers to find out what it is.

The Morning Stars, while able-bodied and reliable, are not venturers. They are not even deep thinkers really, and they certainly have no vested interest beyond the coin I supply them. However, I'm dubious of sharing my findings with them for fear it would get back to Harport in an uncontrolled manner. I ask whether the guild can spare any seasoned members to accompany me on a brief return to this site so that our organization can responsibly steward its contents without political interest. Perhaps Lazio is free, I'm sure Sechen would appreciate the reprieve. Regardless, please let me know if and when I can expect guild support to proceed, otherwise I can return with my unfinished charts and we can plan for next spring.

Signed, Wayfinder Alberta de Genne